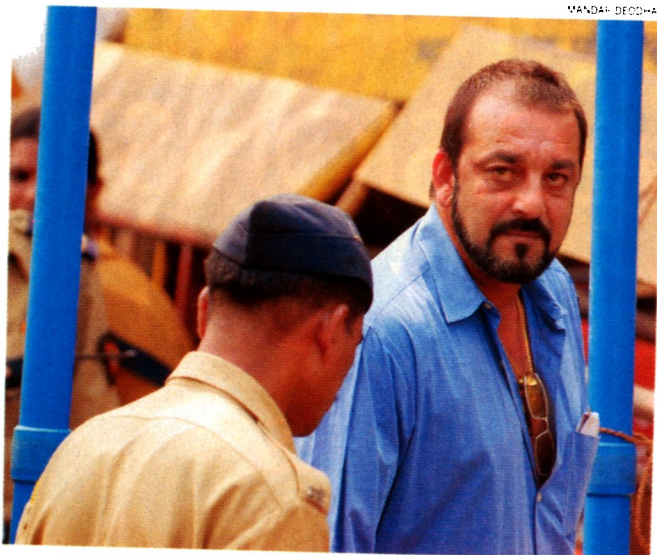


MANDAR DEODHAR



Back Behind Bars

MUMBAI After 60 days of reprieve, actor Sanjay Dutt was taken into custody again on October 22 after the TADA Court handed over a copy of his judgement in the 1993 Mumbai blasts case to him. Dutt had been granted interim bail by the Supreme Court after he was sentenced to six years of rigorous imprisonment under the Arms Act.

This time though there were no curious onlookers or fans to greet him. Dutt himself, unlike last time

when he almost broke down in the court after hearing the sentence, was calm and composed. "He is prepared to face whatever is in store for him," says Dutt's counsel Satish Maneshinde. Soon after his arrest, the star was taken to Mumbai's Arthur Road jail from where he was shifted to Pune's Yerawada jail.

Findings of the trial court have noted that "Dutt did have a nexus" with Anees Ibrahim, brother of underworld don Dawood Ibrahim, two

CAGED: Dutt's misery is far from over

prime conspirators of the 1993 serial bomb blasts case. The judgement copy—which runs into 4,340 pages and weighs almost 25 kg—also adds that there is no evidence to conclude that there was a nexus between them for the purpose of conspiracy (serial blast). The finding of the trial court may impede his chances of getting bail from the Supreme Court but his lawyers remain tight-lipped about it. "We will be approaching Supreme Court for his bail before Diwali," said Maneshinde.

But there may be more trouble in store for Dutt. The prosecution is slated to appeal against the judgement of special judge P.D. Kode who had found Dutt not guilty under the provisions of TADA.

Dutt spent a quiet night at Yerawada jail with prison arrangements remaining unchanged for his second stint. He is likely to continue making cane furniture while in jail. No happy Bollywood finalé this.

by Renu Ojha

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Sawinder Jeet Singh Bajwa, 57, deputy-mayor of Delhi and BJP councillor, who tripped over the low railing of his balcony at home in a bid to chase away monkeys.

CONFERRED: On former president **A.P. J. Abdul Kalam**, the King Charles II Medal for his outstanding contribution



to the practice and promotion of science in India. He is the second leader to receive the award which was instituted in 1997.

AWARDED: Pandit Bhajan Sopori, santoor legend and music composer, by the Jammu & Kashmir Government with its highest civilian award. He is among the first musicians to have played Indian classical music on the santoor.

DIED: Jagdish Prasad Mathur, 86, one of the founder members of the erstwhile Jan Sangh and the Bharatiya Janata Party.

VIS-A-VIS

BAL THACKERAY Shiv Sena supremo **versus** **ABHISHEK MANU SINGHVI** Congress spokesperson

Even though I am physically weak, my thoughts are far from tired. As long as I have the people on my side, I will never tire.



SAURABH SINGH

Thackeray behaves like a leader but has no party left. He is searching amidst the wrecks and ruins of his rank and file.

EPILOGUE: The results of BMC polls show the ageing tiger is still on the prowl.